

GTM Opportunity Progress Tracker — Field Guide

Executive summary

This field guide explains how to use the GTM Opportunity Progress Tracker to create a single, auditable view of each opportunity's commercial motion — from first qualification through close and deployment. The tracker is designed to reduce forecast noise, standardise stage definitions, and make handoffs (Sales → Solution → Delivery → CS) explicit. It provides: (1) a consistent data dictionary, (2) a stage progression playbook with measurable exit criteria, (3) deployment status and risk scoring taxonomy, and (4) example prompts for analytics (SQL) and retrieval-augmented answers (RAG) with guardrails for compliance.

Product overview: the Tracker tool

The Opportunity Progress Tracker is a lightweight layer that sits between your CRM and downstream reporting. It normalises key fields (stage, close date confidence, deployment readiness) and tracks artifacts (discovery notes, security review, pricing approval, SOW) required to progress. Typical users include Account Executives, Sales Engineers, Deal Desk, and Customer Success. The tracker can be implemented as a CRM custom object, a data warehouse table with a curated semantic model, or a spreadsheet-based pilot with controlled permissions.

At-a-glance

What it solves	How it works	Outputs
Inconsistent stage interpretation	Stage gates with explicit exit criteria and required artifacts	More stable forecast rollups
Missing handoff context	Ownership + SLA per stage; notes and artifacts tracked as links	Faster internal alignment
Deployment surprises post-close	Deployment status taxonomy + risk scoring rubric	Earlier risk visibility

Data dictionary (core fields)

Use these definitions consistently across CRM, forecast calls, and BI dashboards.

Field name	Description	Example	Source system
opportunity_id	Stable unique identifier for the opportunity.	0068X00000ABC123	CRM
account_id	Stable account identifier; used for rollups and dedupe.	0018X00000ZZZ987	CRM
stage	Standardised GTM stage (see Stage Playbook).	3 — Solution Fit	CRM (mapped)
stage_entered_date	Date the opportunity entered the current stage.	2026-07-18	CRM / Tracker
expected_close_date	Best estimate close date with current knowledge.	2026-09-30	CRM
close_confidence	Numeric confidence 0–100 based on evidence, not sentiment.	75	Tracker (calc)
primary_use_case	Business problem statement category for the deal.	Fraud detection	CRM / Notes
champion	Named person who benefits from the solution and drives internal approval.	A. Rivera (VP Ops)	CRM
economic_buyer	Final budget authority for the purchase.	M. Chen (CFO)	CRM
security_review_status	Status of security/privacy review for the buyer.	In progress	GRC / Tracker
pricing_approval_status	Internal approval status for discounting / terms.	Approved	Deal Desk
required_artifacts_links	Links to required documents (deck, SOW, architecture).	Confluence/Drive URLs	Docs
deployment_status	Delivery readiness state (see taxonomy).	Ready — Pilot scheduled	Delivery / CS
deployment_risk_score	0–100 risk score from rubric (higher = riskier).	42	Tracker (calc)

Implementation notes: map CRM stages into the standardised tracker stages; compute close_confidence using evidence-based signals (artifact completion, champion confirmation, security review milestones). Track required artifacts as immutable links; avoid copying sensitive content into free-text fields.

Stage progression playbook

Exit criteria should be objective and verifiable. SLAs are typical targets; adjust to your business.

Stage	Exit criteria	Artifacts	Owner	SLA (days)
1 — Qualify	ICP match confirmed; problem statement documented; next meeting scheduled with champion.	Discovery notes; initial timeline; stakeholder map (draft).	AE	7
2 — Discover	Success criteria agreed; buyer process understood; mutual action plan (MAP) started.	MAP v1; call recordings/notes; pain/impact quantification.	AE + SE	14
3 — Solution Fit	Proposed architecture validated; demo/use-case proof aligns to success criteria.	Solution brief; demo plan; technical validation checklist.	SE	21
4 — Commercial Align	Pricing + packaging aligned; legal/compliance path known; exec sponsor engaged.	Pricing worksheet; redlines list; approval ticket.	AE + Deal Desk	14
5 — Commit	All approvals complete; signature plan confirmed; delivery kickoff scheduled.	Final SOW; security review outcome; order form.	AE	10
6 — Closed Won / Handoff	Handoff completed; deployment plan accepted; success metrics and owners assigned.	Handoff doc; implementation plan; success plan.	AE → CS/Delivery	5

Operational tip: if an exit criterion is not met, do not progress the stage — update the 9 and log the blocker. This keeps forecast discussions grounded in evidence rather than optimism.

Deployment status taxonomy & risk scoring

Deployment status is tracked starting at Stage 3 to prevent post-signature surprises.

Deployment status	Definition	Typical signals	Recommended action
Not started	No delivery plan or resources identified.	No kickoff date; no environment info.	Create deployment plan; assign delivery owner.
Blocked	Known dependency prevents progress.	Security questionnaire pending; data access missing.	Escalate dependency; document blocker.
In progress	Kickoff done; work actively underway.	Backlog created; weekly cadence set.	Track milestones; update risk weekly.
Ready — Pilot scheduled	Pilot date confirmed; prerequisites complete.	Sandbox provisioned; success criteria agreed.	Run pilot; capture results for go/no-go.
Ready — Production scheduled	Production plan approved and scheduled.	Change window booked; runbook reviewed.	Finalise cutover; monitor readiness checklist.
Live	Customer is in production with defined success metrics.	Usage tracking enabled; adoption plan in motion.	Move to CS adoption motion; measure outcomes.

Risk scoring rubric (0–100)

Dimension	Score guidance	Example
Stakeholder risk (0–25)	0: champion + EB identified and engaged. 25: no champion confirmed or turnover likely.	Champion left; EB unknown → 20+
Technical risk (0–25)	0: validated architecture and tested integration. 25: unknown constraints or untested connector.	Needs on-prem connector not proven → 18
Commercial risk (0–25)	0: approved pricing and standard terms. 25: discount unapproved or legal stalled.	Non-standard terms awaiting counsel → 15
Delivery readiness (0–25)	0: kickoff scheduled and prerequisites complete. 25: no resources or prerequisites missing.	No data access; no PM assigned → 22
Total (0–100)	Sum of all four dimensions. Thresholds: 0–30 Low risk, 31–60 Medium risk, 61–100 High risk.	Total 42 → Medium risk

Operational tip: store the dimension sub-scores to explain the total. Re-score at each stage change, and always after security review or legal redlines. The goal is not to punish teams; it is to surface hidden work early.

Example prompts & compliance guardrails

Use RAG for narrative and artifact retrieval; use SQL for precise metrics and filtering.

Prompt type	Sample prompt	Expected output
RAG (artifact-grounded)	"Summarize the latest Mutual Action Plan for Opportunity 0068X00000ABC123. Include next steps and owners. Cite the source."	Bullet summary with citations/links to MAP and notes.
RAG (risk explanation)	"Why is deployment_risk_score above 60 for Acme Co? List contributing dimensions and recent changes."	Narrative explanation referencing stored sub-scores.
SQL (pipeline health)	"Show count of opportunities by stage and median days-in-stage for the last 90 days."	Table/chart of stage counts + median age.
SQL (SLA breaches)	"List opportunities where days in current stage exceed SLA_days for that stage, ordered by severity."	Ranked list with delta days and owners.

Compliance & guardrails

Guardrail	Policy	Practical implementation
PII/PHI handling	Do not store sensitive personal data in free-text notes.	Use references/IDs; restrict artifact access; enable DLP scanning.
Customer confidentiality	Only retrieve artifacts the user is authorised to access.	Enforce row-level security + document ACL checks.
Prompt injection resistance	Treat retrieved text as untrusted; do not follow artifact instructions.	Use system policy; strip tool instructions; cite sources.
Auditability	Every change to stage, risk, and close date should be traceable.	Write immutable change log with user, timestamp, old/new value.
Retention	Retain tracker data per corporate retention schedule.	Apply lifecycle rules; purge export copies.

Reminder: use SQL outputs for decisions that require exact counts, dates, and thresholds; use RAG outputs for summaries and context when grounded in approved artifacts. Always verify high-impact decisions against source-of-truth systems.